

Citation and Attribution Guidelines

1. Overview

Proper citation and attribution of sources is fundamental to academic writing. These guidelines describe when and how students must cite sources to avoid plagiarism.

2. When to Cite

- Any direct quotation from a source, even a single phrase
- Any paraphrase or summary of another's idea, argument, or finding
- Data, statistics, charts, or images from external sources
- Theories, models, or frameworks developed by a named scholar
- Course materials, textbooks, and lecture notes

3. Accepted Citation Styles

Students should use the citation style required by their discipline and instructor. Approved styles at Westbrook include: APA (7th edition) for social sciences, education, and nursing; MLA (9th edition) for humanities; Chicago (17th edition) for history and arts; ACS for chemistry; IEEE for engineering.

4. Common Knowledge Exception

Facts that are widely known and not attributable to a specific source (e.g., 'The Earth orbits the Sun') do not require citation. When in doubt, cite. Consulting a subject librarian or the Writing Center is encouraged.